BEST CLOSED: OUR MATERIAL CYCLES

We try to use materials that aren't merely recycled but, above all, recyclable. And that means circular.

Ever since FREITAG was founded, we've been thinking and acting in cycles and working with used materials.To ensure that even the most durable bag doesn't end up in the trash after its second or third owner, we are trying to make things more and more circular.

So we intend to use more materials that can be returned to the cycle at the end of the bag's life and continuously increase their share of our range.

You can see how we plan to achieve this goal and what we already do on our Circularity Roadmap.

■ DISCARDED TRUCK TARPS

Truck tarps are robust and long-lasting, and even when used are still a good source material for our kind of bags. Our upcycling approach is designed to extend the life of this durable material.

After spending an average of six years on the road, the tarp assumes a new role and survives for many more years as a bag. External calculations have shown that using old truck tarps instead of new material reduces our CO$_2$ emissions by 22%.

Since 2022, we've also been repurposing the reflectors stuck onto the tarps themselves and making them part of our Reflected Bags.

To ensure the safety of our products, we test incoming truck tarps for undesirable constituents and separate unsuitable ones. Before transforming the tested tarps into bags, we wash and disinfect them. This way, we can be sure to eliminate bacteria or mold.

Unfortunately, the polyester/PVC compound can't be separated. So, after spending their long second lives as FREITAG bags, the tarps end up in the trash. To help prevent this from happening in the future, we've started working on a project with other partners: We're developing a circular truck tarp.

CAN A PRODUCT MADE OF PVC BE SUSTAINABLE? +

YOUR RAW MATERIAL COMES FROM THE STREET. ARE FREITAG PRODUCTS REALLY SAFE? +

YOUR BAGS ARE MADE LARGELY FROM OLD TRUCK TARPS: IS IT OK TO CARRY FOOD IN THEM? +

Answers to the questions people often ask about our materials – and much more – can be found in our FAQs. Or just drop us a message using our contact form.

■ OPERATIONS

TRUCK SPOTTING AT FREITAG

→ TO TRUCK SPOTTING

■ OPERATIONS

FROM TRUCK TILL BAG

→ TO PRODUCTION

■ POLYAMIDE 6: THE MULTIFUNCTIONAL (MONO-)MATERIAL

For the Mono[PA6] Backpack, we use polyamide 6, PA6 for short, better known as nylon. The first circular FREITAG backpack is made entirely from this material: from the outer fabric to the buckles and sewing thread, a total of 17 different components are made from PA6. Thanks to its mono-materiality, the backpack can be easily recycled as a whole at the end of its life, thus conserving resources.

However, restricting production to this one material is more complex than it might sound. Specifically because the search for an existing water-repellent fabric made from a single material was unsuccessful. Until now, such textiles have traditionally needed an additional coating or membrane made from other materials. So, working closely with a partner in the textile industry, we've developed a new kind of fabric, a mono-material that's also water-repellent. After an extensive development phase, the innovative fabric, which contains three layers made exclusively of polyamide 6, finally passed all its material tests.

■ WORN-OUT SKI BOOTS

To ensure our smartphone protective cases are circular despite the rapidly changing sizes of devices from one generation to the next, we use recycled thermoplastic polyurethane (TPU-R) made from worn-out ski boots.

This mono-material is recyclable up to seven times. It's flexible, robust and shock-absorbent, and therefore ideal for making custom-fit smartphone sleeves from it repeatedly. What is special about the new TPU-R material, in addition to the take-back system, is the very short distances in the supply chain: the entire production process, from raw material procurement to preparation and processing to the final product itself takes place in Switzerland within a radius of 150 km from Zurich.

For the development of this product, FREITAG cooperated with a Swiss developer and manufacturer of plastic filaments and with a Davos-based recycling specialist, where people with disabilities dismantle old ski boots and prepare them for new applications.

■ PRODUCT STORIES

DISCARDED PET BOTTLES

→ OUR REFLECTED BAGS

■ DISCARDED PET BOTTLES

The fabrics used as the linings for our bags or as the main material for some models are made of 100% recycled PET and dyed using spinneret technology. In this process, the yarn is dyed during the actual spinning rather than as a finished fabric.

The method is much more environment-friendly than traditional dyeing because it requires 75% less water, 90% fewer chemicals and 30 to 40% less energy.

■ AIRBAGS AND TENSION BELTS

It's not just truck tarps that eventually get discarded: when you're looking for used materials that deserve a second life, road traffic can prove to be a real treasure trove. The most recent examples of this are the two ex-airbags-now-turned-bags launched in 2024 (and unfortunately out of stock at the moment): the small F700 ARROW and the extra-large F708 FIREBIRD. Both shoppers are made from discarded airbags that are now serving their second purpose. They were once installed in cars but fortunately remained unused. The material is lightweight but resilient, and thanks to the variety of colors, seams, and overprints available, comes in a surprisingly wide range of looks. Used tension belts, which become soft and supple after intensive periods of use on Europe's truck routes, were converted into handles for the two airbag shoppers, each one of which is a one-off.

■ SELECTED B-STOCK

B-stock goods, or «seconds», are materials or articles that don't make it into our usual sales channels for any of several reasons: they may not meet the high quality standards for their original purpose, have minor visual defects, or have been used as display items. Provided this does not compromise their quality for our intended use, we give such B-stock goods from other industries a new lease of life.

Currently, we're transforming B-stock seat belts into a variety of new products. In the past, we also used B-stock airbag material for the pop-up F707 STRATOS backpack.

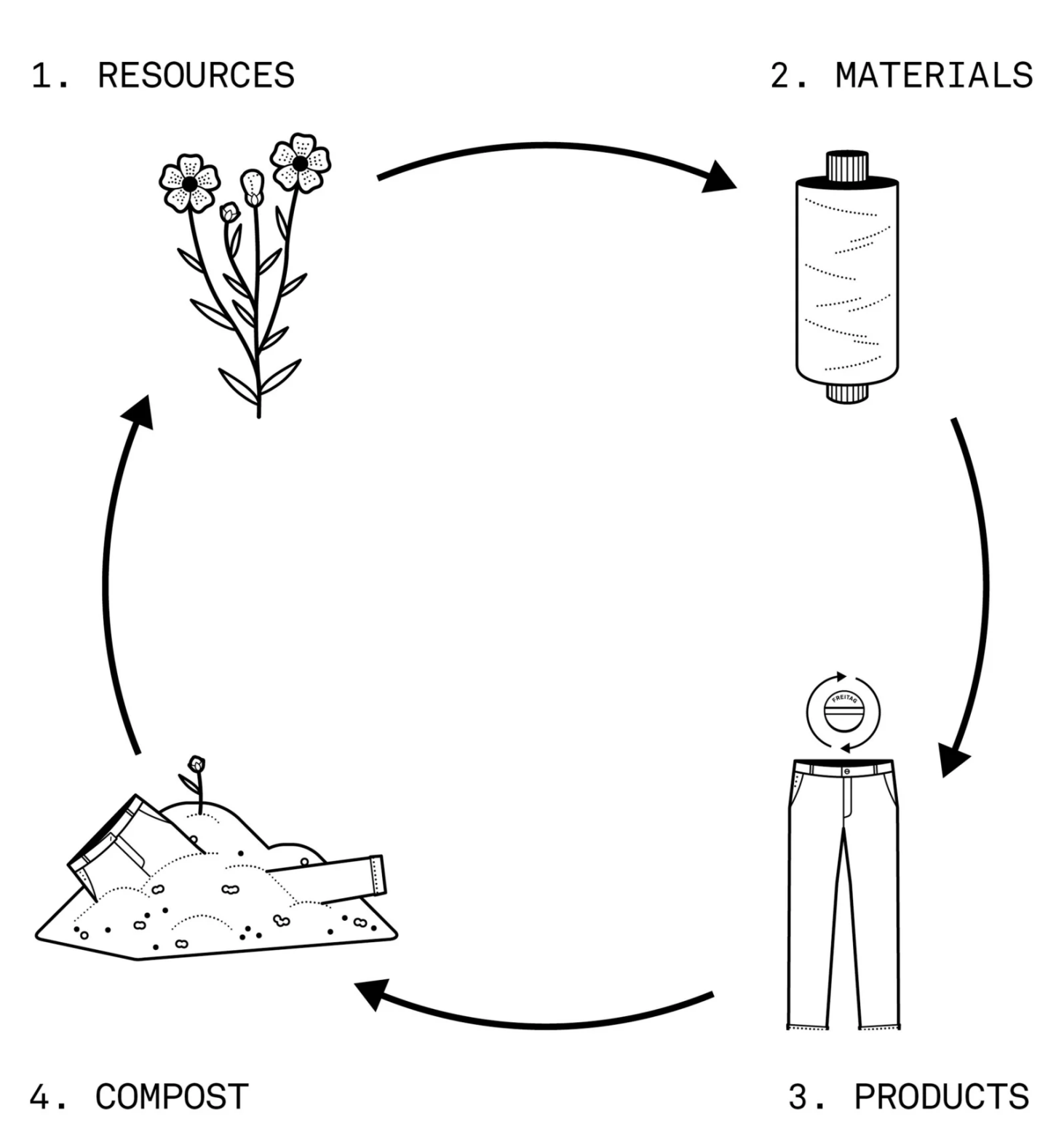
■ NEW MATERIALS

We only use new material where we have not yet found a recycled alternative that meets our quality standards. This principle applies to zippers, buckles and snap fasteners, for example, which must be particularly resilient. You can find all replacement parts for free in the Spare Parts Store.

■ PRODUCT STORIES

ACCIDENT-FREE AIRBAGS

→ THE EX-AIRBAGS-NOW-TURNED-BAGS



■ NATURAL FIBERS

From 2014 to 2023, we produced F-ABRIC, a clothing line made of textiles developed in-house and containing bast fibers (linen and true hemp) and modal. The material was produced in Europe with minimal use of resources, is hard-wearing and fully biodegradable.

The raw materials for F-ABRIC all came from European growers. The focus was on preserving soil quality, using water efficiently and not using pesticides. We also kept the use of chemicals as low as possible during processing and dyeing. Every stage in the production of F-ABRIC took place a maximum of 2,500 kilometers away from Zurich.

F-ABRIC textiles come without rivets, zippers and synthetic constituents and are 100% biodegradable. Our garments become breeding grounds for new raw materials, and we thus close the biological cycle.

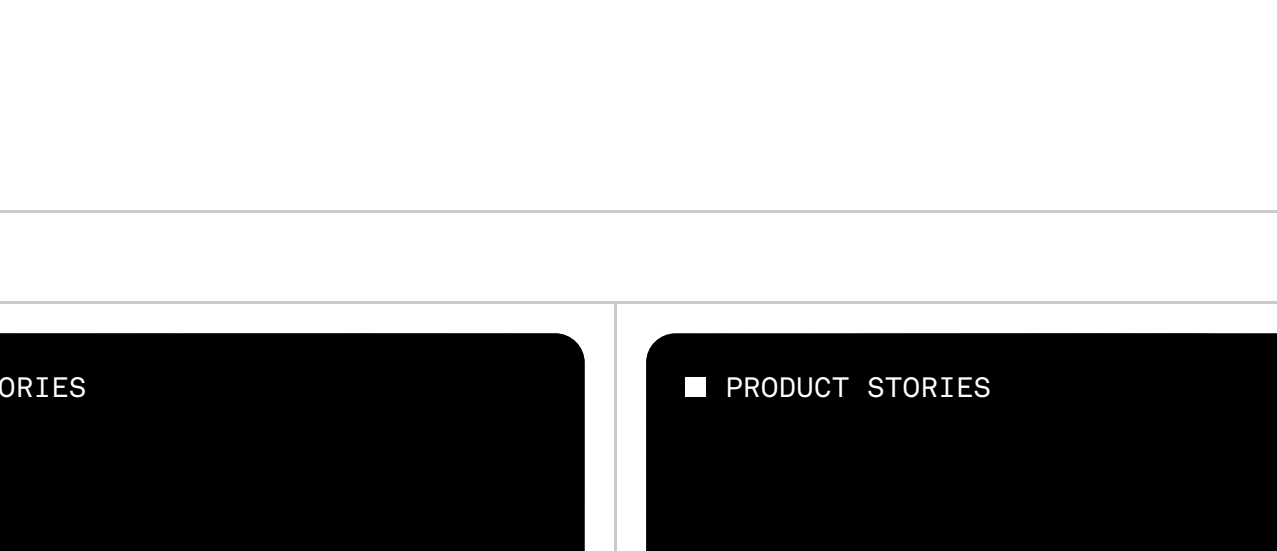
However, since we would now like to devote ourselves increasingly to closing various technical cycles – the development of a circular truck tarp and a circular backpack, for example – we will no longer be producing or further developing F-ABRIC.

■ YOU MIGHT ALSO LIKE

F511 SKIPPER
355.00 EUR

F511 SKIPPER
355.00 EUR

F41 HAWAII FIVE-0
180.00 EUR



F511 SKIPPER
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■ YOU MIGHT FIND THIS INTERESTING

■ PRODUCT STORIES

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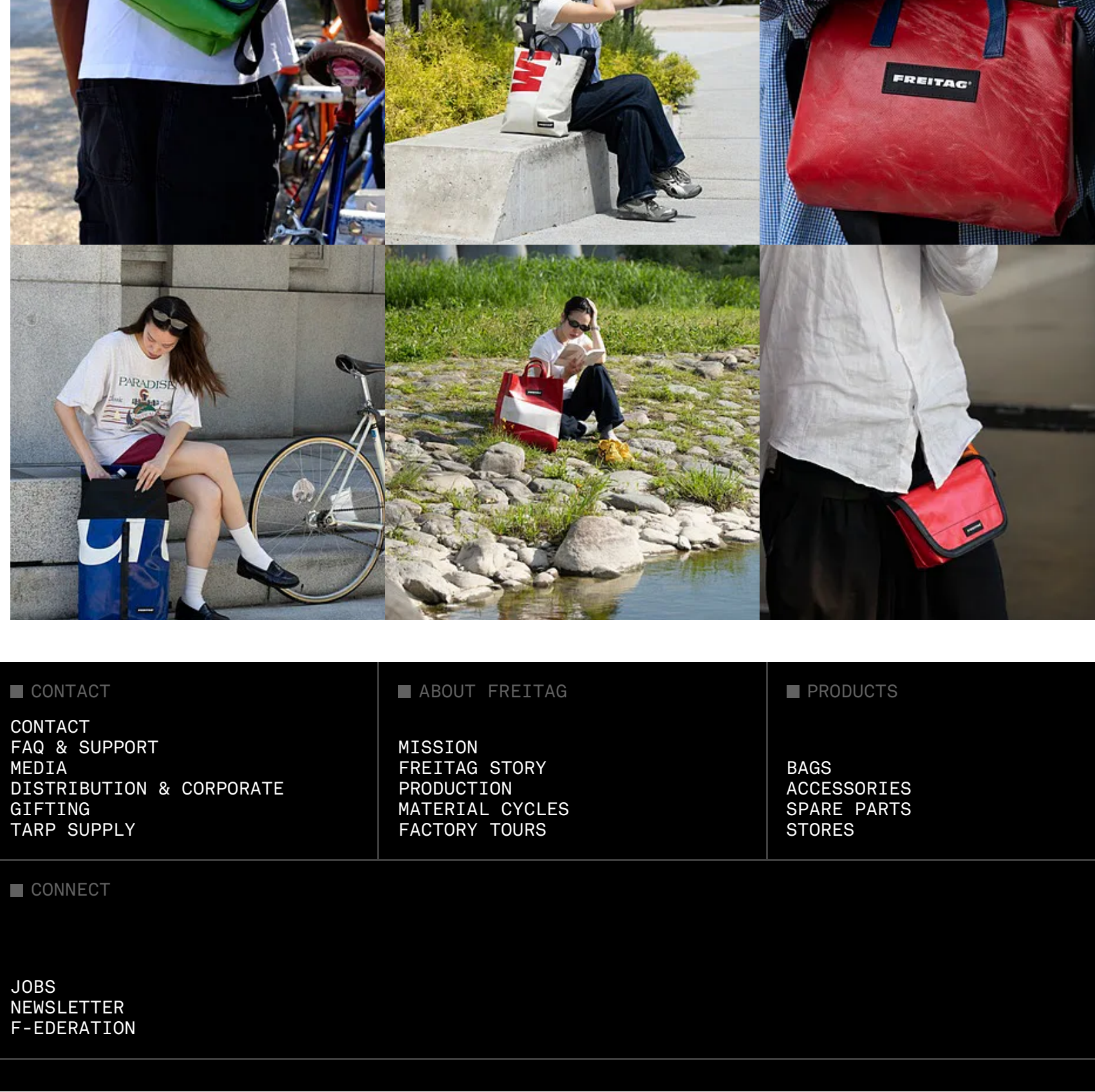

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